This traditional, creamy soup is often served with oyster crackers, although crusty bread is also good. The clams must be cooked on the day of purchase.

new england clam chowder

SERVES 4 **PREP** 15 MINS **COOK** 35 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

36 live clams
1 tbsp oil
4oz (115g) thick-cut bacon, diced
2 floury potatoes, such as russet, peeled and cut into ½in (1cm) cubes
1 onion, finely chopped
2 tbsp flour
2½ cups whole milk
salt and freshly ground black pepper
½ cup half-and-half
2 tbsp finely chopped flat-leaf parsley

1 Discard any open clams, then shuck the rest, reserving the juices. Add enough water to the juices to make 2½ cups. Chop the clams. Heat the oil in a large, heavy saucepan and cook the bacon over medium heat for 5 minutes or until crisp. Remove and drain on paper towels.

2 Add the potatoes and onion to the pan and cook for 5 minutes or until the onion has softened. Add the flour and stir for 2 minutes. Stir in the clam juice and milk and season to taste. Cover with a lid, lower the heat, and simmer for 20 minutes or until the potatoes are tender. Add the clams and simmer gently, uncovered, for 5 minutes. Stir in the half-and-half and reheat without boiling. Serve sprinkled with the bacon and parsley.

SHUCKING CLAMS



Work the tip of a knife between the top and bottom shell, then twist upward to open the clam.



Sever the muscle at the top, then do the same at the bottom to release the clam meat.